



GIANT MONITOR LIZARD VERTEBRA

Varanus priscus

A huge monitor lizard, *Varanus priscus* grew to 7 m (23 ft) in length. It is found in rocks of Pleistocene age.



DIMETRODON SKULL

Dimetrodon loomisi

Noted for a sail-like structure on its back, *Dimetrodon* was an early relative of mammals from the Permian Period. A high skull and short snout translated into a powerful bite.



CYNODONT SKULL

Cynognathus crateronotus

A carnivore with a stout skull and large canine teeth, *Cynognathus* belonged to a group of mammal precursors called cynodonts. It is found in Triassic strata.



eye socket

PLESIOSAUR FLIPPER

Cryptoclidus eurymerus

Growing up to 8 m (26 ft) in length, *Cryptoclidus* was a long-necked plesiosaur from the Jurassic Period.



DICYNODONT SKULL

Pelanomodon sp.

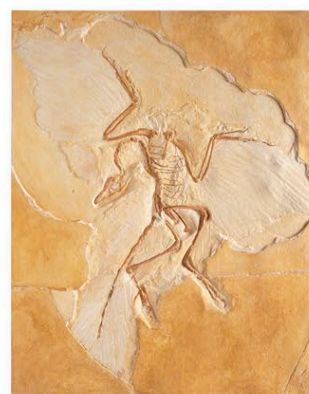
This tuskless herbivore was a dicynodont – a member of a group of mammal relatives that lived in the Permian and Triassic Periods.



MARINE TURTLE SKULL

Puppigerus crasscostata

Fossilized marine turtles are found in rocks ranging from the Mesozoic Era to Recent times. *Puppigerus* had a heavy shell and is found in Eocene strata.



EARLIEST BIRD

Archaeopteryx lithographica

Archaeopteryx was thought to be the earliest bird. However, recent finds in Jurassic rocks in China are challenging that view.



GIANT GROUNDBIRD SKULL

Phorusrhacos inflatus

A carnivore up to 2.5 m (8¼ ft) tall, *Phorusrhacos* was a flightless bird with a powerful beak. It is found in Miocene rocks.



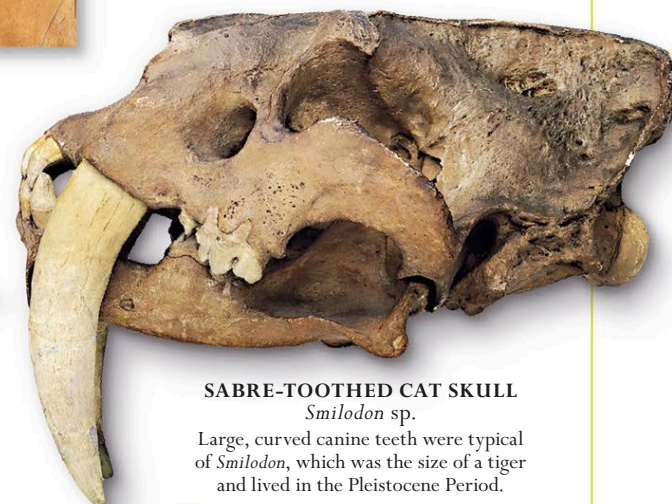
vertebrae



EARLY HORSE TEETH

Protorohippus sp.

A dog-sized, many-toed ancestor of the modern horse, *Protorohippus* is found in Eocene strata. It had low-crowned molars.



SABRE-TOOTHED CAT SKULL

Smilodon sp.

Large, curved canine teeth were typical of *Smilodon*, which was the size of a tiger and lived in the Pleistocene Period.



EARLY ELEPHANT JAW

Phiomia serridens

Found in Eocene to Oligocene strata, *Phiomia* was 2.5 m (8¼ ft) tall. It had tusks in its upper jaw, and a small trunk.



low, sloping forehead

ANTHROPOID SKULL

Proconsul africanus

The first fossil anthropoid (ape-like primate) to be found in Africa, *Proconsul* comes from Miocene strata.



NOTOUNGULATE

Toxodon platensis

Growing to about 2.7 m (8¾ ft), *Toxodon* had a sturdy body with a hippopotamus-like head. It lived from Pliocene to Pleistocene times.